ONKAR SINGH PAHWA

The Quiet Force Behind India's Most Trusted Avon Cycles

Chairman and Managing Director of the Avon Group

In Ludhiana, a city long known for its manufacturing grit, Onkar Singh Pahwa has spent more than five decades building a business through discipline, consistency and a sense of responsibility. He is not one for grand statements or public spectacle. His work has spoken for him, steadily and over time. In 2025, that work was recognised with the Padma Shri, honouring a life devoted to Indian industry.



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Onkar Singh Pahwa joined his family business in 1973, stepping into an enterprise that was already known for making bicycles affordable for the common Indian household. Avon Cycles itself traces its origins back to 1948, when the founders began assembling bicycle components, followed by the complete manufacturing of bicycles in 1952.

Rather than entering directly into leadership, Pahwa spent years understanding operations from the ground up. He worked closely with production teams, suppliers and dealers, learning how each link in the chain mattered. That early grounding shaped the way he would later lead.

Over the decades, Avon Cycles expanded steadily under his guidance. What began as a domestic manufacturer grew into one of India's largest bicycle producers, manufacturing millions of bicycles annually. Today, Avon exports its products to more than 60 countries, taking Indian-made bicycles to markets across Europe, Africa, Latin America and Asia.

The company's manufacturing plants are located at G.T. Road Ludhiana, Neelon (Chandigarh Road) Ludhiana and Hajipur, Bihar, allowing Avon to efficiently serve both domestic and export markets. These facilities operate with a strong focus on efficiency and environmental responsibility, with production waste sent for recycling to minimise environmental impact.

While Avon is best known for its bicycles, the company's product range has grown significantly over time. It is under Onkar Singh Pahwa's leadership that the new and modern bicycle designs were first introduced into the Indian markets. From classic roadsters and children's cycles to mountain bikes and city bicycles, Avon adapted its designs to changing consumer needs.

In recent years, the company expanded into electric mobility and fitness, introducing CYCLELEC electric